

The Adventure of **LIVING** with JESUS



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Begin the Adventure

Something real has begun in your life.

When you asked Jesus Christ to come in, you stepped into a personal relationship with God that will never end. The One who created you now lives within you, and Jesus promises to take you as you are and make your life extraordinary, Christ-centered, and purposeful.

It is the beginning of a new way of living—with Jesus Himself as your leader.

My Heart, Christ's Home

Many years ago, Robert Boyd Munger described what it felt like when he first invited Jesus into his life. He pictured his heart as a home, and Jesus as the welcomed guest who began to settle in:

“One evening I invited Jesus Christ into my heart. What an entrance He made! It was not a spectacular, emotional thing, but very real. Something happened at the very center of my life. He came into the darkness of my heart and turned on the light. He built a fire on the hearth and banished the chill. He started music where there had been stillness, and He filled the emptiness with His own loving, wonderful fellowship.”

Munger then imagined Jesus walking through each “room”—his thoughts, his desires, his relationships, his work, his free time, even the private places he felt ashamed to open to anyone. In every room, Jesus offered to bring light, order, and life.

Munger's story illustrates how Jesus will transform your life inside out as you surrender every area of your life to Him and let Him be in charge of it. This booklet shows you how to begin this adventure with Jesus as you learn to let Him change you to become all God created you to be so that you can do all that He created you to do.

Walking the Path Ahead

The Christian life is more like a marathon than a sprint. There will be days of clarity and days of confusion, moments of triumph and moments of defeat. Ordinary days and spectacular events. What remains constant is the presence of Christ and the patient work of His Spirit within you.

He has already given you everything you need to take this journey.

What You Will Discover

This booklet is a guide for your new life in Christ. In the lessons ahead, you will explore:

1. **Citizen of Heaven** — the assurance of your eternal belonging and secure future with God
2. **Your New Identity in Christ** — who you truly are now that you belong to Him
3. **The Holy Spirit – Your Constant Companion** — the power and presence of God living in you
4. **Walking by Faith, Not by Feelings** — how to trust God in every situation
5. **God’s Word – Your Road Map** — the Bible shows a reliable path for your steps
6. **Prayer – Your Ongoing Conversation with God** — learning to talk with your heavenly Father
7. **Belonging to God’s Family** — the strength and joy of life with other believers
8. **Living a Life of Purpose** — how God sees your new life from His eternal purpose

Each lesson includes Bible verses, thoughtful questions, and space to respond. Move at a pace that allows the truth to settle in your mind and heart. Look up the verses. Speak honestly with God as you go.

The goal is not merely to finish these pages but to begin living the everyday adventure of walking with Jesus.

He is already with you. Your journey awaits.

Are you ready to take the next step?

1. Citizen of Heaven

Are you certain you would go to Heaven if you died today?

The Bible tells us we can know for sure.

Even after inviting Jesus into your life, you may still wonder. This section is written to give you clear, biblical confidence that you belong to Christ—now and always.

God's Free Gift

Jesus Christ paid the full price for all your sins on the cross. Through His death and resurrection, you have been given direct access to God. God's perfect justice has been completely satisfied by the blood of Jesus. He has purchased you—and there are no returns (Hebrews 7:25; 9:12).

Because this gift is so complete, a natural question often arises: “What about the good things I have done? Don't they somehow contribute?”

The Bible answers this question with clarity. Read the following verses carefully and write what each one reveals about who is responsible for your salvation:

Romans 5:8

Ephesians 2:8-9

Titus 3:5-6

1 Peter 3:18

Eternal life is a gift from God. You cannot do anything to earn it.

However, like any gift, you can choose to accept or reject it. It's your free choice

How to Join God's Family

Q: According to 1 John 5:11-13, and John 3:15-18, what is the one requirement of having eternal life in heaven?

In the original Greek language, the word “believe” means to trust in, cling to, and rely upon. In other words, “believe” in the original Greek language is an active faith—much like the faith rock climbers have in the rope to hold them secure. Becoming a Christian means placing that kind of trust in Jesus: relying fully on His death for your sins and His resurrection for your eternal life.

Faith versus Feelings

Christianity is a relationship with Christ—based on faith alone! Your faith is to be based on the facts in the Bible ... not feelings (See 2 Timothy 3:16). Faith in Christ may result in feelings ... and often does. But emotions are unpredictable and unreliable, and you can’t depend upon them. Therefore, it is essential to rely on what God communicates in His Word, the Bible!

Where Are You Going After You Die?

Q: Read 1 John 5:11-13. If you have Jesus Christ in your life, what are you sure of?

_____ Q: Once you have put your faith in Christ, is there anything that can separate you from God’s love? What does Romans 8:38-39 tell us?

_____ Q: Will Christ ever leave you? What does Hebrews 13:5 have to say?

_____ Q: For how long will God forgive your sins? Read Hebrews 8:12.

As God’s child, He will always love you—even when you fail Him. He will never give up on you—even when you give up on Him. Keep walking with Him.

Your Faithful Friend

The Bible tells you that Jesus is the friend who remains closer than any other. He is loyal, present, and unchanging—someone who will never leave or forsake you.

Ashley's Story

"I always put my friends above God. In fact, my life revolved around my friends so much that I began to get involved in reckless behavior just to seem 'cool' to others.

"Pretty soon I got involved in drugs, sex and alcohol. My life got out of control, and I felt worthless, with no purpose other than to get 'high.' Then I even lost my friends, who called me 'trash.'

"One day someone told me that Jesus Christ not only created me, but wanted to be my best friend. I couldn't believe it at first. Later, I decided to invite Him into my life. Since then, God has given me a new purpose in life and helped me break my addictions. I now have many new friends, but the greatest of all is Jesus Christ. He accepts me for who I am, and tells me that 'He will never leave or forsake me'" (Hebrews 13:5).

Ashley discovered what millions of others have discovered about Jesus: He is our best friend. No other friend loves you so much or will stick with you so closely (Proverbs 18:24). Jesus is totally loyal and faithful (Proverbs 20:6).

Growth is God's Plan for You

God does not leave you to figure out the Christian life on your own. From the beginning, He has a clear path for your growth:

1. Walk in the Holy Spirit
2. Trust God with your life
3. Know and trust God's Word
4. Talk with God in prayer
5. Connect with other believers
6. Live a life of purpose

These are not requirements to earn His love. They are the natural ways a new life in Christ begins to take shape. As you move through the rest of this booklet, look up the verses, respond honestly, and ask God to form these patterns in you. He is already committed to the work He has begun.

Go Deeper

Assurance of Your Salvation

2. Your Identity in Christ

The moment you trusted Christ, your identity changed forever. You are no longer defined by your past, your performance, or the opinions of others. You are now a child of God, with a new nature and a secure place in His family.

C. S. Lewis points out, “Mere morality is not the end of life. You were made for something quite different from that... The idea of reaching ‘a good life’ without Christ is based on a double error. Firstly, we cannot do it; and secondly... we have missed the very point of our existence.”

Lewis explains that the point of our existence centers on the tremendous inheritance we have in Christ as His children. Living for Christ is not our duty as His slaves, but our privilege as His sons and daughters.

Your Inheritance in Christ

As a Christian, you have been given a remarkable inheritance. Take time to read the following verses and thank God for what is now true of you:

- Your sins are completely forgiven (Colossians 2:13-14)
- You become a child of God—forever (John 1:12)
- Christ actually comes into your life (Revelation 3:20)
- The Holy Spirit is your guarantee (2 Corinthians 1:22)
- Christ gives you His nature (2 Corinthians 5:17)

A New You

“Therefore, if anyone is in Christ, the new creation has come: The old has gone, the new is here!” (2 Corinthians 5:17)

You are now a completely new creation—like a butterfly that was once a caterpillar. You may not always feel new or act new, but in God’s eyes you are fully new. The Father sees you as the one His Son purchased with His own blood. You are His royal child (Hebrews 2:9-11).

The apostle Peter describes believers as living stones being built into a spiritual temple, with Jesus as the cornerstone:

“And now God is building you, as living stones into His spiritual temple ... You are a chosen people. You are a kingdom of priests, God’s holy nation, His very own possession” (1 Peter 2:5, 9).

God says wonderful things about you. In Christ you are:

- Living Stones in His Spiritual Temple
- A Chosen People
- A Kingdom of Priests
- His Very Own Possession
- Citizens of God’s Holy Nation

It does not matter what your background, abilities, appearance, or status may be. You now belong to Christ’s body with believers from every time and place. You are a full citizen of heaven (Ephesians 2:19).

Your thoughts:

More like Christ

God’s plan is to conform you into Christ’s image (Romans 8:29). Jesus’ Spirit living in you has begun this change, and He will continue his work throughout your life (Philippians 1:6).

Q: Whose work is it according to Philippians 2:13?

Q: What qualities do you most value in a close relationship?

Go Deeper

Embracing Your New Identity in Christ

3. The Holy Spirit — Your Constant Companion

Ready in Heart, but Not Yet Empowered

The disciples were deeply moved after the resurrection and eager to follow Jesus wherever He led. Yet even after three years of walking with Him, they still lacked the power to live the life He had called them to live. Enthusiasm alone would not be enough.

Jesus knew they needed more. He told them, “You will receive power when the Holy Spirit has come upon you” (Acts 1:8). Before leaving, He instructed them to wait for the promise of the Father: “I will send the Holy Spirit, just as my Father promised” (Luke 24:49, NLT).

The Holy Spirit is given many names in Scripture, yet His primary work in your life is to be your Encourager and Comforter as you walk with Christ (John 16:7-15). Without Him, living for Christ is impossible. With Him, you can do all things through the strength He supplies (Philippians 4:13).

The Indwelling Holy Spirit

When you invited Jesus Christ to be your Savior and Lord, He entered your life through the Holy Spirit—and He will remain with you forever. You are never alone.

Ephesians 3:16-17 says that God strengthens you with power through His Spirit in your inner being, so that Christ may dwell in your hearts through faith. As Robert Munger pictured it, Jesus desires to settle into every “room” of your life, bringing light, warmth, and life. Christ lives in you by His Spirit.

Who Is the Holy Spirit?

Though invisible, the Holy Spirit is a real Person—the Spirit of Jesus (John 14:16-21).

Read the following verses and note what they reveal about Him:

Q: Acts 5:3-4

Q: John 14:16-17

The Bible makes clear that the Holy Spirit is fully God—one with the Father and the Son. As you yield areas of your life to Him, He brings purpose and meaning. The process is gradual and will include setbacks, yet “the one who began a good work in you will perfect it until the day of Christ Jesus.” (Philippians 1:6, NASB).

The Battle Within

Every day, you face influences from within and from the world about you that are pulling you away from God and going against His will—temptations, anger, addictions, jealousy, dissensions, hostilities, and other destructive behavior (Galatians 5:19-21). Even good things such as family, success, and security can come between God and you when they become the center of your life. True satisfaction comes only when you give Jesus His rightful place: the “throne” of your life (Matthew 6:33).

The apostle Paul writes about the struggle to live for Christ. In Romans 7, Paul writes about his desire to live for Christ but his repeated failures. He learned that this battle of his flesh (sinful nature) versus the Spirit can only be won when we surrender our wills to the Holy Spirit. Paul explains in Romans 8 how he achieved victory through the Holy Spirit.

As long as we live in this body, the conflict between self-centered desires and Christ’s way will remain. The question is which voice we will follow.

Q: What does Galatians 5:16-18 say about this inner conflict?

5:16-23, contrast the two ways of living:

The Self-Directed Life

The Filling of the Holy Spirit

Scripture says, “Live by the Spirit and you will not carry out the desires of the flesh” (Galatians 5:16, NASB). To be “filled” with the Spirit means to be directed and controlled by Him. A basketball player willingly places himself under the coach’s direction in order to play well and win the game. In the same way, we freely choose to place ourselves under the Spirit’s leadership.

Q: What does Ephesians 5:18 instruct us to do?

A New Way of Living

God’s purpose is to conform you to the image of Christ (Romans 8:29). This lifelong process is the work of the Holy Spirit as you give Him control moment by moment. There is tremendous freedom in giving control over to Him. You will no longer be imprisoned by self-centered cravings and passions.

The diagrams below illustrate two ways a Christian can live. In one, self remains on the throne. In the other, Christ is given His rightful place. The difference is not in whether a person has received Christ, but in who is allowed to direct daily life.

The motivation for yielding control is not duty or pressure. It is the love of Christ. “Christ’s love controls us... He died for all so that those who live would no longer live for themselves” (2 Corinthians 5:14-15, NASB).

Todd’s Story

“For three years I wanted nothing more than to join the most popular group at my high school—the Mavericks. Even after becoming a Christian, I still thought it might be harmless, even though it was a drinking club.

I finally decided I needed to go all out for Christ. That same week I was invited to join the Mavericks. I immediately knew that the stakes were high, and that Satan was trying to derail my decision. Instead of giving in, I turned my life fully over to God. He gave me freedom I had not known before and a purpose that reached beyond myself.”

A Simple Step of Surrender

Giving control of your life to the Holy Spirit is a decision of faith, just as receiving Christ was a decision of faith. You simply place yourself in the hands of a trustworthy God.

You might pray:

“Lord Jesus, I want my life to be directed by You rather than by self. I confess the ways I have lived independently of You. Holy Spirit, I ask You to take control of my life right now.”

Q: What does this kind of commitment mean to you?

Restoring Fellowship

At times, believers sin and break fellowship with the Holy Spirit (1 John 1:8). This does not mean your salvation is lost. Jesus paid for all your sins on the cross, once and for all. Broken fellowship means that you are not abiding in Christ. If it is not mended, you will not experience the abundant life Jesus promised and will begin to miss His purpose and plan for your life.

You can return and restore your fellowship with God at any moment. The way back is simple:

1. Yield yourself again to God.
2. Confess your specific sins
3. Trust the Spirit that He is in control.

Spiritual Breathing

Walking in the Spirit is a moment-by-moment dependence on Him. One helpful picture is what Bill Bright called “spiritual breathing.” Just as physical breathing involves exhaling what is harmful and inhaling what gives life, we “exhale” sin through honest confession and “inhale” the Spirit’s control by faith.

Whenever you become aware of sin or self-centeredness, you can turn quickly: confess it, and by faith entrust yourself again to the Spirit's leadership. He is always ready to restore and empower you.

Go Deeper

[Who Is the Holy Spirit](#)

4. Walking by Faith, Not by Feelings

God's power to live for Christ and walk in the Holy Spirit is available to us only through faith.

Q: What does Hebrews 11:6 say about faith?

Faith is a steadfast trust in God that results in action. Living for Christ is not trying to do what Jesus did in our own strength, but letting Him live His life through us by faith—trusting Jesus enough to do whatever He tells us to do, exactly as He wants it done.

As we live by faith, Jesus' love will shine through us. Genuine faith in Christ produces obedience to God's Word, the Bible, even though there will be ups and downs (James 2:17).

Your faith will be tested throughout life. Scripture describes the Christian life as a battlefield with three persistent enemies: the world, the flesh, and the devil. God has given us powerful means to overcome these enemies.

Q: Read Ephesians 6:10-18. What are the keys to winning this battle?

Overcoming Doubt

Joni's Story

Joni Eareckson was an active, athletic teenager until the day she dove into shallow water and broke her neck. In a moment, the future she had imagined was gone. She would never walk or use her hands again.

Although she had trusted Christ as a teenager, the months that followed her injury shook her deeply. "In those first few months," she later wrote, "the promises of God seemed anything but true... How could I be expected to believe when everything inside and outside of me screamed just the opposite?"

Through the steady encouragement of a friend and the truth of God’s Word, Joni began to choose faith over her feelings. Looking back, she has said that her paralysis was not a cruel joke but was used by God’s love. Today she leads an international ministry that shares the hope of Christ with people affected by disability.

Her life reminds us that victorious faith is not the absence of struggle. It is trusting God even when we cannot yet see the reason.

Victorious Faith

Hebrews 11 introduces us to men and women who trusted God despite great adversity, opposition, and even suffering. Faith in God always pleases God and results in a life of victory over any circumstance.

Read Hebrews 11 and note what stands out to you about those who walked by faith:

A life without faith, on the other hand, is disastrous for God’s people.

God performed spectacular miracles to save the Israelites from slavery in Egypt—ten plagues in Egypt, the parting of the Red Sea, and daily provision in the wilderness. Yet they soon forgot and began to doubt His promise of a good land (Promised Land) and bright future (Read Exodus chapters 3 through 20).

When twelve spies of Israel were sent out to scout the Promised Land, they returned with a report that the land was “flowing with milk and honey,” but occupied by giants. Only Joshua and Caleb were willing to move forward in faith. The rest of the people turned back in fear. As a result, that generation wandered for forty years in the wilderness, never to enter the rest God had prepared for them. (Read chapters 13 and 14 in the book of Numbers.)

Q: What “giants” in your life currently make trust difficult?

Q: Read Hebrews 3:7–4:16.

According to this passage, how do we enter God’s rest?

Q: What does the passage warn us against?

God still promises rest to those who trust Him. Victorious faith is simply taking God at His Word and moving forward, even when circumstances or emotions suggest otherwise.

Examining Your Trust

What in your life keeps you from trusting God fully— Relationships, finances, plans, habits, past failures, thought life, fear, or the desire for control?

Ask God to reveal them to you. Write down any area God shows you and take it prayerfully back to God to help you change the way you think about it. Your faith will be strengthened when you first change your perspective and way of thinking.

“Don’t copy the behavior and customs of this world, but let God transform you into a new person by changing the way you think. Then you will learn to know God’s will for you, which is good and pleasing and perfect.” (Romans 12:2, NLT)

Go Deeper

Faith: Knowing Who You Can Trust

5. God's Word – Your Road Map

If you received a personal letter from Jesus telling you how much He loves you and offering clear direction for your daily life, would you read it carefully? Would you return to it often?

That is what the Bible is—God's own word to you. Just as a new baby needs milk to grow, you need God's Word to grow in your new life.

Before You Begin

Obtain a Bible with good references and helps. There are many English translations. You may find a modern translation easier to understand. Free online Bibles are available at sites such as bible.com in many languages.

God's Road Map for Your Life

If you were traveling to a place you had never been, would you rely only on instinct, or would you use a GPS or reliable map?

While the map will not show you every detail of your travel and what is along the road, it will keep you from heading in the wrong direction, giving you guidance for your trip.

The Bible provides the “road map” for your journey with God. It teaches you all the truth you need for your life.

Forming a New Habit

Most of what we do each day is out of habit. In order to make God's Word part of your life, you need to make it one of your daily habits. Choose a consistent time (many find mornings helpful) and a quiet place. Read a section of the Bible and ask God to show you what He wants you to understand and apply.

Like with any new habit, making God's Word part of your daily life will take time. Be patient and persistent. The more you let His Word dwell in you richly, the more you will experience God's presence and power in your life.

God's Viewpoint

The Bible gives you God's answers to the most important questions of life:

- Who God is

- Your purpose
- How to grow in Christ
- Moral decisions
- Relationships
- Peace and comfort in hardship
- Suffering and death

“For the word of God is living and active and sharper than any double-edged sword... it is able to judge the desires and thoughts of the heart.” (Hebrews 4:12)

What Fills Your Mind

Every day your mind is flooded with the voices and messages around you—most of them reflecting the world’s perspective. What you allow to fill your mind will influence your decisions, attitudes, actions, and direction.

If God’s perspective is to shape your life, you must give your regular time and serious effort to “feed on” His Word.

Matthew Henry once said: “If you want to get close to God, you must study His Word.”

Q: How does Colossians 3:16 speak to you personally?

Five Ways to Take in God’s Word

1. Hearing God’s Word

You can hear Scripture taught through:

- Local church gatherings
- Faithful Bible teachers
- Small groups and studies
- Trusted online resources

- Christian audiobooks

Q: In what ways are you currently hearing God's Word? How could you increase that?

Q: What does Acts 17:11 encourage us to do when we hear teaching?

When you hear God's Word taught, listen for what the Holy Spirit is trying to teach you personally. Taking good notes and writing down your thoughts will help you remember and apply His teaching.

2. Reading God's Word

Read slowly and thoughtfully. Keep a pen to underline or note what stands out. If you are new to the Bible, start with the Gospel of Mark or the Gospel of John. Then read the book of Acts that records the actions of the early Christians. The Gospel of Luke and Acts were both written by Luke and together give you key events in the first century from the birth of Jesus to the explosive growth of the church.

"All Scripture is God-breathed and is useful for teaching, rebuking, correcting and training in righteousness" (2 Timothy 3:16).

Q: Which book of the Bible are you currently reading? What is the Holy Spirit showing you?

3. Studying God's Word

Study can take different forms:

- An individual book
- A single chapter or passage
- A theme (such as love, forgiveness, or faith)
- A key verse

- A central truth of the faith

The goal is not information alone, but insight into who God is and what He wants to do in your life.

One simple way to study is to read a short passage slowly, then ask: What does this show me about God? About myself? About how I am to live? Write down what you notice.

Q: Read 2 Corinthians 5:14-17 in one or two translations. What does this passage mean to you?

4. Memorizing God's

Word

Hiding Scripture in your heart gives you truth to carry into every situation. Begin with a few key verses. Write them on small cards, review them regularly, and speak them aloud. Over time, they become part of your inner vocabulary.

"I have hidden your word in my heart that I might not sin against you." (Psalm 119:11).

5. Meditating on God's Word

Meditation is simply turning a truth over in your mind throughout the day. When stress, temptation, or uncertainty arises, bring a relevant verse to mind and let it steady you.

Q: What does Philippians 4:6-7 offer in moments of anxiety?

The Power of God's Word to Transform

In the late 1970s, David Berkowitz—known as the "Son of Sam"—was imprisoned after a series of murders in New York. While in prison, he was given a Bible. As he read, the Word of God began to confront and change him. In time, he turned to Christ in genuine repentance. Today he serves as a chaplain's assistant, a living example of how Scripture can break old patterns and create a new life.

Transformation happens as the world's perspective is gradually replaced by God's. The amount of time you commit to the Bible is probably the single best indicator of your walk with Christ, and the best predictor of your future growth in Christ.

"Let the word of Christ dwell in you richly" (Colossians 3:16).

Q: Read Psalm 1:1-3. What picture does it give of a life rooted in God's Word?

_____ As you continue walking
with Jesus, let His Word become the steady foundation of your life.

Go Deeper

Renewing the Mind for Transformation

6. Prayer – Your Ongoing Conversation with God

Imagine you are having lunch with a friend when your phone rings. An unfamiliar voice speaks your name and says, “This is your Heavenly Father. I have been wanting to talk with you.”

How would you respond—surprised, hesitant, grateful, or unsure?

God desires that kind of open conversation with you. He wants you to know Him well enough that you feel free to come to Him at any time, even when you have sinned. The story of the father and his younger son in Luke 15:11-32 reveals the heart of God who runs toward those who return to Him.

Prayer is one of the great privileges of belonging to Christ. Through Jesus, you have direct access to your Father in heaven. He invites you to bring Him whatever is on your heart, and He promises to listen.

Relationship, Not Rules

When you received Jesus into your life, you entered a personal relationship with God. Every healthy relationship depends on honest communication. Your Father wants you to seek His guidance, peace, and companionship at all times and not only when you need something from Him because He delights in you (Galatians 4:6).

Three truths support a growing life of prayer:

- The Holy Spirit helps you pray
- Faith makes prayer effective
- God’s Word teaches you who He is and how to pray

Jesus said, “Ask and you will receive, and your joy will be complete” (John 16:24).

Knowing Your Father

The more clearly you see who God is, the more you will want to talk with Him. His greatness is far beyond full human understanding, yet Scripture gives us a glimpse of His character in beautiful and magnificent ways:

- Sovereign – in complete control

- Eternal – without beginning or end
- All-knowing
- Present everywhere
- All-powerful
- Unchanging
- Holy
- Just
- Loving
- Completely trustworthy

As you consider each of these attributes, see how it affects your view of God and your relationship with Him. How does it change the way you come to Him in prayer?

Praying with Confidence and Humility

Because you are His child, you are welcome in His presence. The Bible invites you to “approach God’s throne of grace with confidence, so that we may receive mercy and find grace to help us in our time of need” (Hebrews 4:16).

At the same time, God calls you to approach Him with humility. Pride resists dependence; humility opens the way for His help (1 Peter 5:5-6).

True confidence in prayer rests on several truths:

You belong to Him. God hears the prayers of His children. He also hears those who turn to Christ for the first time in faith.

You remain (abide) in Him. Jesus said, “If you remain in me and my words remain in you, ask whatever you wish, and it will be done for you” (John 15:7). A life that remains close to Christ becomes a life of answered prayer according to God’s will.

Q: What does John 15:7 teach about the connection between abiding and prayer?

Q: What warning and encouragement do you find in Psalm 66:18-20?

You desire His will. Jesus modeled this attitude in Gethsemane, submitting His own will to the Father's purpose (Mark 14:32-40). Scripture gives this assurance: "If we ask anything according to his will, he hears us" (1 John 5:14).

You wait with patience. Some answers come quickly; others take years to receive answers. Patience is a sign of a Spirit-controlled life (Galatians 5:22). Many believers can testify to God's faithfulness after long seasons of persistent prayer.

Growing in the Practice of Prayer

Beginning the day A simple way to strengthen your relationship with Christ is to turn to Him at the start of each day. Before the demands of the morning take over, you might say:

"Father, I love You. I want to walk with You today. Lead me in what lies ahead."

Claiming His promises Carry a verse with you and return to it throughout the day. Proverbs 3:5-6 is a steady place to begin:

"Trust in the Lord with all your heart, and do not lean on your own understanding. In all your ways acknowledge him, and he will make straight your paths."

Restoring fellowship When you become aware of sin, name it, and choose to let Him control your life. He will then restore you to fellowship with Him. "If we confess our sins, he is faithful and just and will forgive us our sins and purify us from all unrighteousness" (1 John 1:9). The Spirit Himself helps us in our weakness (Romans 8:26-27).

Thanksgiving and adoration God has already done for you more than you can measure. Many psalms sing praise and gratitude to God. Praying through them is a great way to worship Him (Begin with Psalms 95, 107, 145-150).

Bringing requests Your Father wants you to ask. He delights in your requests since it is an act of faith and obedience. Never quit asking Him for things that are biblical and within His will. He promises to answer those prayers ... in His time!

As you continue in God’s Word and yield to the Spirit, conversation with your Father in prayer will become more natural. Prayer is not a duty to master; it is a relationship to enjoy.

Q: How has your experience of prayer changed since you began following Christ?

Q: What is one step you can take this week to grow in honest conversation with God?

Go Deeper

The Lord’s Prayer Guide Overview

7. Belonging to God's Family

When you trusted Christ, you were not only given a new identity but also you were placed into a new family. You now belong to the body of Christ, joined with believers across every generation and every place.

Christ's Local Body

All who follow Jesus across time make up the Church, the body of Christ. Scripture also uses the word "church" for a local gathering of believers.

Jesus promises us: "For where two or three gather in my name, there am I with them" (Matthew 18:20). When we come together with Him as our focus, He is present.

The Example of the Early Church

The book of Acts shows how the first believers lived out this new family life. They regularly met in homes, shared their lives, and supported one another with deep commitment. The New Testament letters were written to these early communities, and the same Spirit who guided them continues to guide the church today.

Their love for one another and their steady witness were so compelling that the message of Christ spread throughout the Roman world. God worked through ordinary people who took seriously their life together.

Q: As you read the book of Acts, what stands out most about the way the early believers related to one another?

Q: How important were other believers to Paul, Peter, and the other apostles?

Q: How important are other believers to you at this stage of your journey?

Q: What are you currently doing to build relationships with other followers of Jesus?

Why Connection Matters

One of the most common reasons believers are spiritually weak is isolation. Paul taught that every Christian is a necessary part of the body of Christ. Just as every part of the human body has a role—some visible, some hidden—so every believer has a place and a purpose.

Read 1 Corinthians 12:14-27 and reflect on what Paul says about the body:

Q: Who is described as the head?

Q: Who are the members?

Q: Are any members unimportant?

Q: What does Paul say about the parts that may seem weaker (v. 22)?

When believers who are growing in Christ share life together, their faith is strengthened, their burdens are shared, their love for God and others deepens, and they learn from each other. A single coal grows cold when

separated from the fire; however, together, coals keep one another burning. If you are not yet part of a Christ-centered, Bible-teaching church, ask God to lead you to one. He will help you find the right one.

Unique Gifts for the Common Good

God has designed you with purpose. He has given gifts to every believer so that the body of Christ can be built up. In 1 Corinthians 12:4-11, Paul emphasizes several important truths about these gifts.

Q: Who is the source of the gifts (v. 11)?

Q: What does the passage suggest about the relative importance of different gifts (vv. 21-23)?

Q: What attitude are we warned against (v. 25)?

Q: How are we to treat one another when one member suffers or is honored (v. 26)?

Some gifts, such as teaching, may appear more important than others because they are more visible. However, God's Word is clear that each gift is vital to His Kingdom. The entire body of Christ is commissioned and gifted to accomplish Jesus' Great Commission to "go into all the world and tell the Good News to everyone" (Matthew 28:19-20).

Taking Steps to Belong

If you are not yet connected with other believers who love and follow Jesus, you are missing out on God's best for you. He has designed us to be part of His body to build His Kingdom.

How to get started:

- Ask God to lead you to faithful believers
- Look for a church that teaches the Bible and values both community and mission
- Join a small group where you can know others and be known
- Offer the gifts you have for the good of others
- Seek out a mature believer who can walk with you
- Remain open to encouraging someone else in turn

“If we walk in the light, as he is in the light, we have fellowship with one another” (1 John 1:7).

Q: Read Hebrews 10:24-25. How can you apply these verses to your life?

Go Deeper

Connecting with God's Family

8. Living a Life of Purpose

A new identity, walking with the Holy Spirit, faith, the Bible, prayer, and belonging to God's family are not ends in themselves. They are means by which we become all that God created us to be so that we can do all that He created us to do.

Personal Holiness

One of God's defining attributes is holiness. He is morally pure, righteous, and set apart from all. The Holy Spirit has set us apart for God and works within us to transform us in the holiness of Christ to be holy.

Nancy DeMoss writes, "True holiness starts on the inside—with our thoughts, attitudes, values, and motives—those innermost parts of our hearts that only God can see. It also affects our outward and visible behavior: 'Be holy in all your conduct.'"

Q: What does Peter say in 1 Peter 1:15-16?

Q: What does Paul say in 1 Corinthians 6:18-20?

Love for Others

The Holy Spirit actively gives us His supernatural love for others. This love is forgiving rather than resentful, patient rather than irritable, and compassionate rather than unsympathetic. Corrie ten Boom experienced God's supernatural love when she chose to love by faith. She was able to truly love her enemy—the prison guard who demeaned and abused her.

This supernatural love is not the work of our human effort. When, in obedience, we surrender ourselves to the Holy Spirit and become His willing vessels, His love begins to flow through our new nature in Christ.

Q: What does Paul ask in Galatians 3:3?

_____ Q: What solution does he offer in Galatians 2:20?

_____ Q: What does a life directed by the Spirit look like according to Galatians 5:22?

_____ Q: In what areas have you already noticed the Spirit making you more like Christ?

_____ Q: What areas still need to be yielded to Him?

Investing Your Life

Jesus often spoke of life in terms of investment. He made clear that our days, relationships, and resources are meant to count for the growth of His kingdom.

Q: How are you currently investing your life?

In Luke 19, Jesus told of a prince who entrusted money to three servants and later returned to settle accounts. Two had put the resources to work and were commended. The third had protected what he was given but produced nothing. God has given us new life in Christ and expects us to live in such a way that we bear much fruit that remains (John 15:16).

Life on earth is brief. The opportunities to invest your life for Christ are now.

Accountability and Reward

The Bible teaches that every believer will one day stand before Christ and give an account of a life lived in relationship with Him (2 Corinthians 5:10). This is not a moment of condemnation for those who belong to Him, but it is a moment of evaluation and rewards.

Q: What does Paul say in 1 Corinthians 3:11-15 about the way our lives will be tested?

Jesus expects you to invest your life for the greatest possible impact for His Kingdom. Like the prince who rewarded the servants who multiplied their investments, Jesus eagerly looks forward to rewarding you.

The motivation is not earning God's love, for that is already secure in Christ. We invest our lives as our grateful response to His unconditional love and immeasurable grace.

Expanding Your "Territory"

In 1 Chronicles 4, there is a brief story of a man named Jabez. He asked God for "expanded territory" (1 Chronicles 4:9-10) because he wanted to invest his life for the greatest return. In the 19th century, an American evangelist, D. L. Moody, expressed a similar desire in his statement: "The world has yet to see what one man who is totally sold out to Jesus Christ can accomplish. By God's grace, I want to be that man!"

Q: What area of influence or usefulness are you asking God to grow in your life?

Ambassadors for Christ

Paul writes, "We are ambassadors for Christ" (2 Corinthians 5:20). An ambassador represents a sovereign authority in a foreign state. In the same way, Jesus, your King, has commissioned you to represent His Kingdom in this world. You are Christ's witness and God's choice to reach others for Him.

Your witness takes two primary forms: Your walk and your talk

Many people around you quietly carry burdens, disappointments, or hurts. Some are searching for meaning and purpose. You may be the person through whom they first encounter Jesus.

Q: Who are some of the people in your daily life with whom you could share the hope you have found?

Continuing the Journey

The Christian life is sustained by a steady, ongoing dependence on Christ. God's Word tells you how to finish strong:

"Let us strip off every weight that slows us down ... And let us run with endurance the race that God has set before us. We do this by keeping our eyes on Jesus, on whom our faith depends from start to finish" (Hebrews 12:1-2, NLT).

Q: What currently tends to distract or hinder you in walking with Jesus?

Q: What is the most important truth you want to carry forward from this study?

When Christ remains at the center, life begins to take on a different quality, marked by growing peace and joy, a desire to please Him, and a love that extends even to difficult people. God "is able, through his mighty power at work within us, to accomplish infinitely more than we might ask or think" (Ephesians 3:20, NLT).

You do not walk this path alone. The One who called you is trustworthy and remains with you every step of the way. His promises are sure.

"[B]ut those who hope in the LORD will renew their strength. They will soar on wings like eagles; they will run and not grow weary, they will walk and not be faint." (Isaiah 40:31)

“Do you not know that in a race all the runners run, but only one gets the prize? Run in such a way as to get the prize.” (1 Corinthians 9:24)

“For I know the plans I have for you,” declares the LORD, “plans to prosper you and not to harm you, plans to give you hope and a future.” (Jeremiah 29:11)

Go Deeper

God's Plan for You

Continuing with Jesus

You have now explored eight foundational truths for living with Jesus:

1. Citizen of Heaven 2. Your New Identity in Christ 3. The Holy Spirit – Your Constant Companion 4. Walking by Faith, Not by Feelings 5. God’s Word – Your Road Map 6. Prayer – Your Ongoing Conversation with God 7. Belonging to God’s Family 8. Living a Life of Purpose

These truths are not meant to be studied once and then set aside. They are meant to be lived—slowly, steadily, and sincerely—as you walk with Jesus in the ordinary days ahead.

Keep Taking the Next Step

Your walk with Jesus is a spiritual life cycle. You are born as a baby. You are to grow and mature to be a spiritual adult so that you can participate in your Heavenly Father’s business.

In the days ahead, continue to:

- Keep getting to know who God is
- Learn more about who you are in Christ
- Practice reliance on the Holy Spirit in daily moments
- Stay rooted in Scripture and honest conversation with God
- Remain connected with other believers
- Share with others what you are discovering

Q: What is the most important truth you want to practice from this study?

Q: What is one specific next step you will take this week?

A Closing Prayer

“Lord Jesus, thank You for the new life You have given me. Thank You for Your Holy Spirit, Your Word, and Your people. Help me to walk with You by faith each day. Continue to change me from the inside out, and lead me in the purposes You have for my life. Amen.”

The adventure of living with Jesus has just begun. You have stepped into God’s epic story. You have an indispensable part to play. **Keep walking with Him and see what will unfold next.**

Additional Resources

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